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MARIGOLD

Digital cash in fixed notes.

Notes you hold, hand over, and understand.

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THE PROBLEM

Digital Money Forgot What Cash Got Right

Take a dollar bill out of your wallet. Notice three things:

1**Whoever holds it owns it.**

There is no account, no login, no intermediary. Possession is ownership.

2**It carries no memory.**

The bill does not remember who spent it last. There is no record tying you to the coffee you bought this morning.

3**Anyone can check it is real.**

Hold it to the light, feel the paper. No special expertise required.

No mainstream digital money reproduces all three of these properties at once.

Bitcoin gives you the first and third: holding your keys means owning your coins, and anyone can verify the system is honest. But it fails badly on the second. Every Bitcoin ever mined carries its full history permanently and publicly. Every address you have ever sent from or received to is stitched together in a graph that anyone can analyze. Your coins remember everything you ever did with them.

Privacy coins like Monero and Zcash try to fix this by encrypting the history. They succeed at hiding things — but the very cryptography that does the hiding creates two new problems. First, almost nobody can personally verify that the system is honest. You are trusting experts you have never met that the math contains no flaw, no backdoor. Second, regulators take one look at the complex cryptography and classify the coin accordingly — delistings, restrictions, and adversarial treatment follow not from what the coin does but from how it does it.

The result is a landscape where you choose between transparency without privacy, or privacy without trust. Physical cash offered both, effortlessly. Digital money somehow forgot how.

THE INSIGHT

Don't Hide the Trail — Don't Make One

Imagine you are at a market stall. You hand a five-dollar bill to the vendor. The vendor puts it in the register. Later that day, the vendor spends that same bill at the bakery. The bakery gives it as change to the next customer.

Now ask: who can trace that bill back to you? Nobody. Not because the bill's journey was encrypted or hidden — the bill was in plain view every step of the way — but because the bill itself never recorded who handed it to whom. The connection between you and the vendor was never written down. It existed only in the moment of handover and then was gone.

This is the difference between hiding information and never collecting it.

Privacy coins hide. Marigold doesn't collect.

HOW IT WORKS

Notes Instead of Accounts

Most cryptocurrencies work like bank accounts. You have an address (like an account number), and transactions move value between addresses. The addresses are public, and every movement between them is recorded forever. It is an accountant's dream and a privacy nightmare.

Marigold works like cash. There are no accounts. Instead, the system maintains a pool of **notes** — think of them as digital banknotes.

Each note is a simple public record:

- A **serial number** (like the serial number on a dollar bill)
- A **value** (0.01, 0.1, 1, 10, 100, 1,000, 10,000, or 100,000 MAGLD)
- A **lock** (a public key – whoever holds the matching key can spend it)

That's it. No owner name, no address, no identity. The note does not know who holds it. It knows only that a key exists, and that whoever can unlock it can spend it.

MAKING A PAYMENT

Paying someone is like handing over a bill, with one extra step:

1. **You give the recipient the key** to the note (via QR code, text message, or even verbally — the same way you'd share a photo).
2. **The recipient immediately swaps the lock** — they record a transaction that replaces your key with a brand-new key that only they know. This is confirmed in under a second.

Once that swap is confirmed, the note is irrevocably theirs. You no longer hold a key that works. Settlement is done.

Alternatively, if the recipient can send you their new key ahead of time (say, via a payment request), you can swap the lock directly to their key. Your key never travels anywhere.

The third way is for paying someone who is not there. You swap the lock to a key only they hold and put a deadline on it. Until the deadline, only they can take the note; from the deadline on, only you can take it back. They collect when they like; if they never do, the money is yours again by itself. The deadline is enforced by the network, not by anyone's wallet.

All three end the same way: the note sits under a key that only the recipient knows.

PRINT IT, SPEND IT

Every note in your wallet app can be displayed as a **QR code**. You can print that QR code on a piece of paper, fold it up, and put it in your leather wallet — right next to your credit cards and your driver's license. That piece of paper *is* the money. Show it to someone, and they scan it, swap the lock, and the note is theirs. You no longer hold a working key. The paper in your pocket is now worthless — the value has moved to them.

This is not a metaphor. The printed QR code holds the actual key. Losing it is like losing a hundred-dollar bill: whoever finds it can spend it. Keeping it safe is the same responsibility as keeping cash safe. There is no recovery hotline, no "report this stolen" button, no bank to reverse the transaction. That is what bearer means, and it is the entire point.

GIFT IT

A birthday card with a printed QR code inside is indistinguishable from a birthday card with a fifty-dollar bill inside. The recipient scans it, swaps the lock immediately, and the note is irrevocably theirs. No account to set up, no waiting period. They open the envelope, they hold the money.

LEAVE AN INHERITANCE

A sealed envelope in a safe deposit box, containing printed QR codes for several notes, functions exactly like an envelope of cash. Whoever opens it holds the keys. Whoever holds the keys holds the notes. No executor, no probate court, no third-party permission is needed for the value to transfer — though, as with physical cash, the *legal* arrangements around inheritance are a separate matter the system does not and cannot address. The system guarantees only that possession of the key is possession of the note.

PAY AT A MARKET STALL

You are buying tomatoes. The vendor displays a QR code — their payment request. You scan it with your wallet app, select the note you want to pay with, and your phone swaps the lock directly to the vendor's key. Under one second later, the note is theirs. You pocket your tomatoes. The vendor never saw your name, your address, or your account. You never saw theirs. The transaction is settled, final, and forgettable — just like cash.

BE PAID WHILE YOU ARE AWAY

Publish one key — on your business card, in your shop window, in your profile — and anyone can pay you at any hour. Each payment lands under a fresh key that only your wallet can work out from the one you published, so the chain never shows two payments arriving at the same place. A payment to it can carry a deadline, so the sender knows the money comes back to them if you never collect. Your wallet collects whatever is waiting the next time it is running.

STORE IT COLD

Worried about hackers? Print your notes as QR codes, put them in a fireproof box, and delete the app. The notes exist on the blockchain. The keys exist on paper. No internet-connected device holds them. When you want to spend, scan the QR code back into a wallet app, swap the lock immediately (in case someone copied the paper while it was stored), and transact normally.

Every few seconds, every participant verifies a single rule:

All notes in existence + all coins on the traditional side
= total coins ever mined

VERIFIED BY EVERY NODE · EVERY BLOCK

If this does not hold, something is wrong and the network can see it immediately. Supply is accountable at every moment — not by trusting an auditor, not by trusting a complex proof system, but by the kind of arithmetic anyone can do.

No value is ever created or destroyed within the system. Paying a fee removes a note from the pool, but its value is credited to the miner and can be recreated as a new note at any time. The conservation rule is absolute and universal.

SPEED

The Chain: Fast Enough to Feel Like Cash

The settlement rule is simple: a note is yours when your lock swap is confirmed on the network. That means **confirmation time is handover time**. On Bitcoin, you would stand at the market stall for ten minutes. On Ethereum, about twelve seconds. On Marigold, under one second.

BITCOIN

10 min

ETHEREUM

~12 s

MARIGOLD

< 1 s

Marigold runs on a proof-of-work blockchain that produces approximately 10 blocks per second, giving sub-second confirmation. The underlying technology was built by the Kaspa project — a fast, reliable, well-tested blockchain. Marigold adds the note system and its economics on top of that foundation, leaving the base layer intact because it does its job exceptionally well.

A note on energy. Marigold's energy story is not that it uses little — a proof-of-work chain attracts as much mining as its rewards are worth, and a successful Marigold will be no exception. The story is that none of it buys waiting. A classical blockchain can accept only one block per round; blocks mined in parallel are thrown away, so the network stays secure only by staying slow. The chain Marigold runs on keeps every block — blocks found at the same moment are woven into the ledger together, all of them counting — which is how the same security budget delivers ten blocks per second and sub-second settlement instead of a ten-minute queue. Per payment, that is an enormous efficiency difference. In total, it is the same honest arithmetic as everything else here: energy spent in proportion to the value being protected.

ECONOMICS

Economics at a Glance

SUPPLY	210,000,000 MAGLD, hard cap. No premine, no dev fund, no allocation of any kind.
LAUNCH	Fair launch from day one. Software available to everyone in advance. Everyone starts on equal footing.
EMISSION	Smooth and gradual — the mining reward halves every three years without sudden drops. About 21% is mined in year one, ~90% by year ten.
BASE UNIT	1 MAGLD = 100,000,000 petals.
COST TO PAY	0.01 MAGLD — one hundredth of a coin — for any everyday payment, however much you are sending. The fee is a single small note handed over with the payment, so a coffee and a car cost the same to move. Only unusually large operations, bundling dozens of notes at once, step up to two or three hundredths.
FEES	All fees go to miners. Nothing is burned, nothing is diverted. A cash economy — where every payment is an on-chain transaction — produces steady fee income that store-of-value chains cannot match.

LAUNCH SECURITY

Training Wheels That Come Off

A new proof-of-work chain has low mining power, and low mining power invites attacks. Marigold launches with a temporary, fully disclosed safeguard called **finality anchors**: five publicly identified trustees periodically co-sign (requiring at least 3 of 5) a recent block, making it permanent and irreversible. No one can undo an anchored block.

The trustees cannot censor transactions, create coins, move anyone's funds, or produce blocks. Their only power is to prevent undoing completed transactions. If they go silent, the chain continues normally as a standard proof-of-work network — somewhat less protected, but fully operational.

The safeguard is designed to retire. Once the network's mining power grows strong enough that attacks are prohibitively expensive, anchors step down from mandatory to advisory to fully expired. Before that happens, the selection of successor trustees is intended to pass to note-holder governance — so even the training wheels' remnant transfers from founders to the community before they are removed entirely.

On the public testnet the safeguard is running now: five trustee keys, an anchor roughly every thirty seconds, every node enforcing. The testnet trustees are throwaway keys made for the rehearsal; the real set is chosen at launch.



Marigold is digital cash. Notes are bearer instruments. Possession of the key is ownership. Transfer of the key is settlement. The chain is complete about value and silent about people — exactly like a dollar bill.

Marigold is not a privacy coin. Nothing is encrypted. Nothing is hidden. The distinction is not euphemism: privacy coins cryptographically conceal recorded data, and Marigold records no data to conceal. What it shares with cash is specific and honestly bounded — the system is complete about *value* by design, and silent about *people* by design.

Marigold is five operations, one conservation rule, plain-view state, ordinary digital signatures, a fixed supply checked by everyone at every moment, on a network fast enough that handing over a note feels like handing over a bill.

Everything it does can be checked by the people it is for.

`marigold.cash · note@marigold.cash · github.com/marigoldcash`

`No token sale. No presale. Nothing to buy yet.`